

Αἴσωπος ὁ μυθολόγος

Aesop the Fabulist and the Art of the Moral Tale

eul_aid: ago

Period: Ἀρχαϊκή [Archaic](#)
Dialect: Μικταὶ διάλεκτοι [Mixed Dialects](#)
Domain: Μυθιστορία [Fiction](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Aesop is a semi-legendary figure of the 6th century BCE. Ancient sources, including Herodotus, describe him as a slave, often from Samos, Thrace, or Phrygia, who gained freedom and served King Croesus of Lydia. His death is traditionally linked to Delphi, where he was executed after offending the citizens. The details of his life are largely anecdotal, derived from later sources like the Roman-era fictionalized biography, the *Life of Aesop*.

No writings by Aesop survive. The fables attributed to him—short, moral tales often featuring animals—were transmitted orally before being compiled in prose. The most influential early collection was made by Demetrius of Phalerum, now lost. The standard corpus derives from later prose and verse collections, notably by Babrius and Phaedrus.

Aesop is foundational to the Western fable tradition. The Aesopic fable became a distinct genre used by orators and philosophers like Socrates to illustrate ethical points. The stories, central to rhetorical education, have had an enduring impact on literature and popular culture.

Works (17)

- Μῦθοι · [Aesopic Fables \(Anonymous Collection\)](#) · 4 passages
- Αἰσώπειων μύθων συναγωγή · [Aesopic Fables \(Augustana Collection\)](#) · 563 passages
- Μῦθοι Δίωνι Χρυσόστομῳ ἀνατιθέμενοι · [Aesopic Fables \(Dionian Recension\)](#) · 2 passages
- Μῦθοι · [Aesopic Proverbs](#) · 16 passages
- Ἐπίγραμμα · [Epigram](#) · 6 passages
- Μῦθος Νικηφόρου · [Fable of Nicephorus](#) · 2 passages
- Μῦθοι ἐν Δωδεκασυλλάβοις · [Fables in Dodecasyllables](#) · 218 passages
- Μῦθοι Ἀφθονίου τοῦ Ῥήτορος · [Fables of Aphthonius the Rhetorician](#) · 44 passages
- Μῦθοι Δοσιθέου · [Fables of Dositheus](#) · 17 passages
- Μῦθοι Λιβανίου · [Fables of Libanius](#) · 3 passages
- Μῦθοι Συντίπα τοῦ Φιλοσόφου · [Fables of Syntipas the Philosopher](#) · 61 passages
- Μῦθοι τοῦ Ἀνωνύμου Βρανκατιανοῦ Ῥήτορος · [Fables of the Anonymous Brancatian Rhetorician](#) · 3 passages
- Μῦθοι Θεμιστίου τοῦ Ῥήτορος · [Fables of Themistius the Rhetorician](#) · 2 passages
- Μῦθοι Θεοφυλάκτου Σιμοκάττου τοῦ Σχολαστικοῦ · [Fables of Theophylact Simocatta the Scholar](#) · 2 passages
- Μῦθοι ἐν δέλτοις Ἀσσηνδελφτίοις σωθέντες · [Fables Preserved-Assendelftian Wax Tablets](#) · 3 passages
- Παροιμίαι · [Greek Proverbs \(Paroemiae\)](#) · 197 passages

